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The impact of anticipated feelings and artist fame on customers' decisions to attend live flamenco shows

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ABSTRACT

Most current research on consumer behaviour focuses on customer satisfaction, trust, and loyalty. However, few studies evaluate the factors influencing customers' decisions to attend live performances, particularly in the context of flamenco. This study aims to fill this gap by examining how anticipated feelings and artist fame impact customers' decisions to attend live flamenco shows. Using a sample of 584 flamenco consumers and applying Structural Equation Modelling, this research finds that anticipated feelings play a crucial role in driving attendance, while the influence of artist fame is more nuanced. The results reveal that while the artist fame does not directly increase attendance, the emotional connection fostered during performances significantly impacts customers' intentions to attend future shows. These findings underscore the importance of prioritising the emotional experience in marketing strategies for live flamenco shows. Additionally, the study highlights the potential for flamenco festivals to enhance the cultural identity and appeal of tourist destinations, contributing to increased tourism and economic benefits. This research provides valuable insights for music industry managers and marketers, suggesting that fostering emotional engagement and authenticity can drive attendance and loyalty in the traditional music sector.

1. Introduction

The music industry and tourism are key contributors to economic growth. In service-based economies like Spain, tourism accounts for approximately 8% of Gross Domestic Product (GDP). In 2020, cultural services, including the music industry, generated €1651 million, representing 0.15% of total GDP and 6.7% of the Spanish cultural sector (Cuenta Satélite de la Cultura en España, 2019). By 2022, the music industry in Spain had recovered its pre-COVID-19 income levels, reaching €807 million (Statista, 2022). Flamenco, recognised by UNESCO as an Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity (Aoyama, 2009; González Santa Cruz et al., 2019), exemplifies a unique blend of artistic expression, cultural tradition, and emotional resonance (Cotter et al., 2019). This is encapsulated in the words of Camarón de la Isla, who famously stated that flamenco has "only one school: to convey or not to convey". As Spain's most emblematic musical genre, flamenco plays a crucial role in shaping tourism demand and destination branding, influencing visitor motivations and cultural tourism strategies worldwide (García-García et al., 2023; Muñoz-Fernández et al., 2023).

Despite its global recognition, there is limited understanding of the factors shaping consumer behaviour towards live flamenco shows. This study addresses this gap by examining the roles of artist fame and anticipated feelings in shaping attendance decisions (Schorch, 2014). Building on the Theory of Planned Behaviour and Social Cognitive Theory, the research also incorporates concepts of cultural commodification and experiential authenticity to explore the emotional and cultural dimensions of flamenco consumer behaviour.

Most existing research on consumer behaviour centres on

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satisfaction, loyalty, and purchase intentions (Hermenegildo-Chávez et al., 2023; Kautish et al., 2019; Pérez Gálvez et al., 2021; Peña-Vinces et al., 2020; Solakis, Peña-Vinces, & Lopez-Bonilla, 2021). However, little is known about how emotions such as anticipated feelings and artist fame influence attendance decisions. This study uniquely explores whether these emotions drive live flamenco shows attendance and how they interplay with perceptions of artist fame.

Using Structural Equation Modelling and a sample of 584 flamenco consumers, this study challenges previous research (Krueger, 2005), which suggests that artist fame is a significant driver of consumer decisions. Instead, the findings indicate that only anticipated feelings influence attendance. These emotions stem from the originality and authenticity inherent in flamenco performances (Aguilar-Rivero et al., 2023; Han & Bae, 2022).

The results previously contradict published research (Krueger, 2005), revealing that the artist's fame does not influence the consumer's decision to attend a live flamenco show; only anticipated feelings do. These findings have clear implications for music industry managers and academia, as this study is pioneering in this field. These anticipated feelings can emerge due to the originality and authenticity inherent in flamenco performances (Aguilar-Rivero et al., 2023; Han & Bae, 2022).

This research is organised into the following sections. First, a theoretical background is provided, explaining the conceptual framework, the variables used, and the hypotheses stated. Then, the method employed and the results obtained are described. The following section discusses the results, and finally, the conclusions, new research directions, and limitations are presented.

2. Theoretical background

Understanding consumer behaviour in the context of live music has been extensively explored in academic literature, with factors such as age, social capital, accessibility, and individual preferences identified as key determinants of attendance (Courty & Zhang, 2018; Evans et al., 2017; Sakalauskas et al., 2021; Yaish & Katz-Gerro, 2012). However, flamenco presents unique cultural and experiential dimensions that necessitate a more nuanced approach. This study examines consumer engagement with live flamenco performances, focusing on two central constructs: artist fame and anticipated feelings. These constructs are situated within broader theoretical perspectives to illuminate the interplay between market dynamics, cultural authenticity, and consumer behaviour.

Cultural commodification, defined as the transformation of cultural expressions into marketable products (Cohen, 1988; MacCannell, 1973), has played a critical role in the global dissemination of flamenco. While commodification enhances visibility and accessibility, it also raises challenges regarding perceptions of authenticity, which remain crucial in shaping consumer decisions (MacLeod, 2006). Authenticity, particularly experiential authenticity, captures the consumer's desire for genuine and meaningful cultural encounters (Korstanje et al., 2021; Wang, 1999). Scholars argue that authenticity is socially constructed and fluid, varying across cultural contexts (Cohen, 2007; Hughes, 1995; Olsen, 2002). Pearce (2012) emphasises the significant role of authenticity in driving consumer satisfaction and engagement, especially in culturally rich experiences like flamenco performances (Matteucci, 2014; Susanato et al., 2024).

In the flamenco context, the tension between commodification and authenticity profoundly impacts consumer perceptions. Commodification elevates the social prestige of attending flamenco events, aligning them with subjective norms by positioning them as desirable and culturally significant occasions. At the same time, experiential authenticity fosters emotional connections that enhance anticipated feelings, enriching the audience's engagement (Lin et al., 2021). Striking a balance between market-driven demands and the preservation of flamenco's cultural essence is essential to ensuring sustainable consumer engagement (Brew, 2023).

These dynamics are further explained through behavioural theories. The Theory of Planned Behaviour and Social Cognitive Theory provide complementary frameworks for exploring how cultural and social factors intersect with individual cognition in shaping consumer decisions. The Theory of Planned Behaviour posits that behaviour is influenced by three core elements: attitude towards behaviour, subjective norms, and perceived behavioural control (Ajzen, 1985; Mathieson, 1991). In the context of flamenco, artist fame aligns with subjective norms by creating a sense of social desirability around attendance. Additionally, it may enhance perceived behavioural control by motivating individuals to prioritise attendance despite logistical or financial barriers.

The Social Cognitive Theory complements the Theory Planned Behaviour by highlighting the role of social networks and sociocultural environments in shaping behaviour (Aker & Wilson, 2013; Phipps et al., 2013). The Social Cognitive Theory suggests that social influences, such as the preferences of peers or community norms, significantly impact an individual's intention to attend cultural events (Kuhlmeier & Knight, 2005). Flamenco, with its emphasis on communal and immersive experiences, exemplifies how social dynamics reinforce attendance intentions, fostering identity alignment within social groups (Mohd Suki, 2013).

By integrating the Theory of Planned Behaviour and the Social Cognitive Theory with the constructs of artist fame and anticipated feelings, this study proposes a comprehensive framework for analysing consumer behaviour in live flamenco performances. As illustrated in Fig. 1, the framework situates these constructs within the broader dynamics of cultural commodification and authenticity, offering a dual lens to examine both cognitive and social dimensions of engagement.

2.1. Artist fame

Music managers analyse consumer experiences and perceptions and how these impact preferences for music attendance, particularly through the aesthetic experience that stimulates recognition of dimensions such as the aesthetic, symbolic, cognitive, social, and influencer-brand factors (Christensen & Calvo-Merino, 2013; Hutter & Frey, 2010; Vicary et al., 2017). Music functions as a communication system within sociocultural contexts and often evolves into a social phenomenon (Chang & Kim, 2022). Artist fame exemplifies this phenomenon, reflecting the accumulation and maintenance of symbolic capital by artists. Fame is constructed through networks that showcase collective interaction between consumers and artists (Bourdieu, 1984). This fame fosters sustainable brands in the music market, translating into broader economic impacts (Palma et al., 2013; Rodner & Kerrigan, 2014).

Flamenco, as a culturally rich art form, has been commodified to enhance the social value of artists through visibility and branding opportunities. This commodification aligns artist fame with subjective

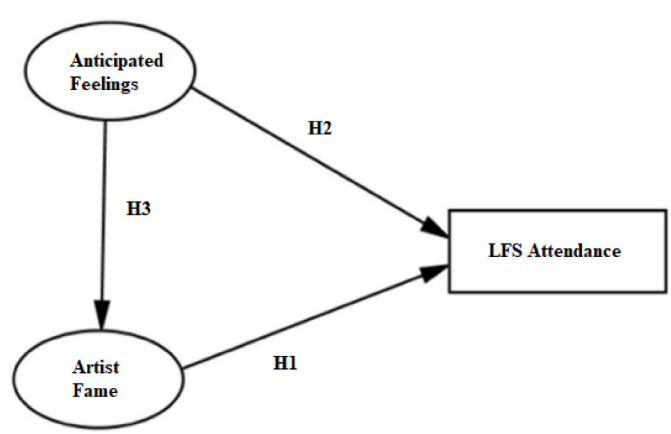

Fig. 1. Proposed conceptual framework.

norms, making attendance at their performances socially desirable and prestigious. From the perspective of the Theory of Planned Behaviour, artist fame reinforces subjective norms by generating social pressure to attend performances, while the Social Cognitive Theory highlights how communal aspects of flamenco, amplified by artist fame, foster collective identity and influence attendance decisions.

According to branding literature, fame establishes content that is relevant for consumers, building self-images that reflect identities and new market roles (Aaker, 1997; Muñiz et al., 2014; Schroeder, 2005). Artists achieve fame assigned by market agents based on both objective and subjective parameters (Velthuis, 2003), which significantly impact consumer perceptions (Meiseberg, 2014). Consequently, identifying and differentiating artists capable of generating consumer reactions is crucial.

Marketing literature identifies differences between artists as brands and their potential to enhance brand equity (Erdem & Swait, 1998). In this context, the artist's brand is inextricably linked to their fame and reputation—whether positive or negative (Bendisch et al., 2013). Artist fame, therefore, proves important for identifying and differentiating artists and can trigger consumer reactions because brand names are associated with opinions, past actions, and future expectations (Franck & Nüesch, 2012; Gómez-Vega & Herrero-Prieto, 2019). Accordingly, the following hypothesis is proposed.

H1. Artist fame positively influences the customer's decision to attend a live flamenco show.

2.2. Anticipated feelings

Feelings are deeply connected to the perceived value and emotional dimension of aesthetic experience (Leder & Nadal, 2014). Music is often evaluated through subjective qualities, with social and environmental aspects playing key roles in shaping perceptions. Music has a unique capacity to evoke sensations that remind spectators of previously experienced emotions (Launay et al., 2016). In the context of flamenco, feelings are defined as an interactive process occurring before, during, and after the performance (Heredia-Carroza et al., 2021). These feelings culminate in the audience's ability to perceive and evaluate the performance's value (Du, 2024; Lee and Min, 2013).

The commodification of flamenco significantly shapes anticipated feelings by transforming emotional engagement into a consumable cultural product. Commodification enhances the visibility of flamenco and elevates its emotional appeal, positioning performances as both aesthetically rich and socially significant. These dynamics are well-aligned with the Theory of Planned Behaviour and Social Cognitive Theory. The Theory of Planned Behaviour frames anticipated feelings as part of attitudes towards behaviour, which influence the audience's intention to attend a live flamenco show. Positive emotional expectations, driven by commodification, create favourable attitudes that encourage attendance.

The Social Cognitive Theory complements this perspective by highlighting how shared emotional experiences during flamenco performances foster communal identity and reinforce social ties. As commodification amplifies the emotional resonance of flamenco, it simultaneously strengthens the communal aspects that the Social Cognitive Theory associates with enhanced engagement and repeat attendance. These theoretical insights underscore how commodification transforms anticipated feelings into a key driver of consumer decisions.

Moreover, the distinctive features of flamenco, such as its idiosyncratic style and sense of community, naturally evoke emotions that influence consumer satisfaction and behavioural intentions (Abraham, 2024; Romero, 1996). The emotional value perceived by audiences is further enriched by the performers, who serve as focal points for the aesthetic and emotional experience (Aguado et al., 2021; Heredia-Carroza, 2019). This interaction between commodification and the intrinsic qualities of flamenco demonstrates the art form's unique ability to elicit powerful emotional responses, which align with the Theory of Planned Behaviour's emphasis on attitudes and Social Cognitive Theory's focus on social influence.

Business and marketing literature (Robinette & Brand, 2001) provides additional insights into the role of emotions in consumer behaviour. The value star model identifies equity, experience, and energy as key emotional dimensions that enhance differentiation, satisfaction, trust, and loyalty (Van Tongeren, 2017; Wei et al., 2024). In the flamenco context, equity reflects the trust and connection audiences feel with live performances; experience captures their interactions with the art form; and energy encompasses the effort invested in attending. These dimensions are amplified by commodification, making anticipated feelings central to consumer engagement. Consequently, the following hypothesis is proposed.

H2. Anticipated feelings positively influence the customer's decision to attend a live flamenco show.

Anticipated feelings and artist fame also exhibit a bidirectional relationship. Anticipated feelings, as psychological states prior to attendance, are influenced by public perception of the artist, while renowned artists amplify anticipated feelings by elevating expectations for emotionally resonant experiences (Kotler et al., 2010; Robinette & Brand, 2001). This interplay highlights how anticipated feelings and artist fame mutually reinforce each other, shaping consumer engagement with flamenco performances. Consequently, the following hypothesis is proposed.

H3. Anticipated feelings positively influence artist fame.

In summary, this theoretical framework integrates cultural commodification, artist fame, and anticipated feelings within behavioural theories such as the Theory of Planned Behaviour and the Social Cognitive Theory to provide a comprehensive understanding of consumer engagement in live flamenco performances. By examining the interplay between these constructs, this study contributes to the existing literature by highlighting the dual role of social and emotional factors in shaping consumer decisions. These insights form the basis for the hypotheses tested, offering a nuanced approach to understanding the dynamics of culturally rich and emotionally resonant experiences.

3. Methodology

3.1. Measurement of variables

The definition and measurement of the key variables in this research are essential for understanding their impact on live flamenco shows attendance. This section outlines the conceptualisation and operationalisation of the primary variables: the customer's decision to attend a live flamenco show, artist fame, and anticipated feelings.

Consumer's decision to attend a live flamenco show is the first variable, conceptualised as a dichotomous variable where flamenco consumers indicate whether or not they attended a live flamenco show during the last year. This variable provides valuable insights into the cultural and artistic preferences of individuals, shedding light on the factors influencing their decision to participate in live flamenco performances. Understanding patterns of attendance helps to uncover the dynamics between audience preferences and the offerings within the flamenco scene (Heredia-Carroza et al., 2020). Moreover, this variable has economic relevance as it impacts the future sustainability of the flamenco industry.

To measure the effects of artist fame and anticipated feelings on live flamenco shows attendance, this research designed and verified a reliable scale inspired by previous studies, analysing the multidimensionality of cultural value (Hernando & Campo, 2017; Klamer, 2003; Throsby, 2003). Focusing on the emotional and branding dimensions of the live flamenco shows, an abbreviated scale was constructed to facilitate the analysis. Each variable used in the construction of these constructs was measured using a 7-point Likert scale.

Artist fame, being associated with opinions, past actions, expected future actions, and the economic profit of artists, was measured through four fundamental elements: the image of the artists, public and expert opinions about them, and the level of ticket sales of their live shows (see Appendix I). This approach draws on previous research (Bendisch et al., 2013; Heredia-Carroza, Palma, et al., 2023a,b), nsuring that the scale captures the multifaceted nature of fame.

Artist fame was measured through four key elements: the image of the artist, public and expert opinions, and ticket sales (see Appendix I). This approach draws on previous research (Bendisch et al., 2013; Heredia-Carroza, Palma, et al., 2023a,b). The image of the artist reflects the personal and professional attributes that shape consumer perceptions and differentiate artists. Aaker's (1997) model of brand personality highlights the significance of these attributes, while Schroeder (2005) underscores their role in positioning artists as unique brands. Public opinions reflect the emotional and cognitive impact of the artist on audiences, driving consumer trust and loyalty (Franck & Nüesch, 2012; Gómez-Vega & Herrero-Prieto, 2019). Expert opinions add legitimacy and prestige to an artist, reinforcing their authority and authenticity (Ohanian, 1990; Velthuis, 2003). Ticket sales serve as an objective measure of market success and consumer interest, reflecting the economic value derived from live performances (Krueger, 2005; Rust et al., 2004). This operationalisation combines subjective perceptions with objective performance metrics to provide a comprehensive framework for understanding artist fame in relation to consumer engagement (Ordanini et al., 2018).

Anticipated feelings were measured based on Hernando's (2017) research, with indicators such as generating emotion in the spectator, generating reflection, feeling flamenco, and making flamenco be felt (see Appendix I). Generating emotion highlights flamenco's ability to evoke strong emotional reactions, central to consumer satisfaction and loyalty (Leder & Nadal, 2014; Robinette & Brand, 2001). Generating reflection refers to the cognitive aspects of flamenco, encouraging introspection and enhancing the perceived value of the experience (Pine & Gilmore, 1998; Schmitt, 1999). Feeling flamenco involves emotional and cultural connection with the performance, with authenticity increasing emotional resonance (Wang, 1999). Making flamenco be felt underscores the artist's role in eliciting shared emotions, strengthening group identity (Bandura and National Institute of Mental Health, 1986) and shaping consumer attitudes (Ajzen, 1985). This construct links emotional experiences with the Theory of Planned Behaviour and the Social Cognitive Theory, offering insights into their role in shaping consumer decisions.

Furthermore, control variables were incorporated into the study to account for potential confounding factors, ensuring the robustness of the findings. Four control variables were used: sex, age, academic level, and knowledge of flamenco (Menor-Campos et al., 2020; Pérez Gálvez et al., 2021). The inclusion of these variables is crucial as they may influence attendance patterns and preferences for live flamenco shows. The person's sex may be associated with different patterns of attending live flamenco shows, while age can reveal preferences and attendance habits across different age groups. Academic level can also impact the interest in flamenco, with higher educational attainment potentially correlating with greater appreciation for the genre. Finally, knowledge of flamenco is an important variable, as individuals with greater familiarity with the genre may have distinct expectations and preferences when attending live flamenco shows.

Together, these constructs and control variables offer a robust analytical framework for exploring the dynamics of consumer engagement with live flamenco shows, connecting emotional and branding dimensions with behavioural theories while addressing potential confounding factors.

3.2. Data collection and sample

The data collection process was carefully designed to ensure the reliability and validity of the responses. The selection of well-established flamenco institutions for survey distribution helped in reaching a targeted audience genuinely interested in flamenco. This methodological rigor contributes to the robustness of the study's findings, offering valuable insights into the attendance patterns and preferences of flamenco consumers.

This approach enabled us to incorporate perspectives from both regular attendees and individuals who engage with flamenco through various other channels. Online surveys were distributed in Spanish by prominent flamenco institutions, including *Flama. La Guía del Flamenco*, the *Centro Andaluz de Documentación del Flamenco*, and the website *promocionmusical.es*, between May and July 2017. The survey instrument was divided into three sections. The first section focused on the attendance profile of respondents; the second section addressed the main variables of the study, namely artist fame and anticipated feelings; and the third section collected socio-demographic data about the flamenco consumers.

The main characteristics of the sample are presented in Table 1. Specifically, 584 completed questionnaires were collected. The majority of the sample (54.1%) comprised male consumers. The respondents primarily belonged to the age group of 'less than 30' (28.1%), followed by the '30 to 39′ group (22.1%). A significant portion of the flamenco consumers (53.9%) held a university degree. Furthermore, the sample demonstrated a high level of familiarity with flamenco, as indicated by their knowledge, the time spent consuming flamenco music, and their attendance at live shows. It is therefore important to note that the sample consists of individuals who identify themselves as flamenco consumers.

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4. Hypotheses appraisal and results

4.1. Structural equation modelling analysis

Most researchers (Lowry & Gaskin, 2014; Peña-Vinces & Urbano, 2015) recommend the use of Structural equation modelling (SEM) when a study variable is composed of latent variables and aims to evaluate multiple relationships simultaneously, as in this case. In this sense, SEM-AMOS 22 software was used to perform the SEM-Analysis. Additionally, SEM-AMOS in recent years has had enormous acceptance as an economic technique in the business and economic field

Table 1
Demographic profile.

Demographic profile			Consumer profile		
Gender	N	%	Knowledge of flamenco	N	%
Masculine	316	54.1	1	30	5.1
Feminine	268	45.9	2	79	13.5
Age in years			3	119	20.4
Less than 30	164	28.1	4	145	24.8
From 30 to 39	129	22.1	5	145	24.8
From 40 to 49	113	19.3	6	42	7.2
From 50 to 59	107	18.3	7	24	4.1
60 or more	71	12.2	**Time consuming flamenco**		
Level of education			Less than a year	34	5.8
None	18	3.1	One to four years	43	7.4
Elementary	69	11.8	Five to nine years	75	12.8
Middle school	100	17.1	Ten or more years	432	74
High school	82	14	**Live show consumption**		
College	315	53.9	Yes	411	70.4
			No	173	29.6

(Triguero-Sánchez et al., 2022). Likewise, considering that our sample size is not small (584 flamenco consumers) and because our research has a confirmatory character, therefore, SEM-AMOS is more recommendable (Solakis et al., 2022; Triguero-Sánchez et al., 2021).

Moreover, before starting any analysis, it is crucial to check if missing data exist. The data imputation process is a normal step in any research (Almeida et al., 2017; Peña-Vinces & Audretsch, 2021). However, Schuschny and Soto (2009) have established that an artificial imputation might be applied when the dataset is below 15% of the whole data. Since the data fall below this threshold, multiple imputation criteria were employed (García-Sánchez et al., 2015; Horton & Lipsitz, 2001) to sort out possible problems of missing data.

Once the above-mentioned stage has been overcome, it is equally important to assess whether there are any additional problems related to common bias (CB) could be detected in the research. Traditionally academics have used Podsakoff et al. (2003) and Harman test as possible remedies to solve the CB problems. However, following to Lowry and Gaskin (2014), those techniques are un-updated and cannot detect CB. Therefore, to validate biased responses and to determine whether the research model was affected by CB was used a Specific Bias Test (SBT). According to Gaskin and Lim (2017) this tool many more powered and accurate to validate it. SBT was performed using anticipated feelings and artist fame variables. The results of the SBT analysis (Table 2) indicated the absence of CB. The results shown in Table 2 from the chi-square difference test between the unconstrained model and the zero-constrained model ($\chi^2 = 15$, $p = 1.000$) indicate no significant difference in fit between the two models. This suggests that the inclusion of constraints to control for common-method bias does not affect the results, thereby ruling out the likelihood of such bias in the analysed data. Therefore, it will be possible starting with the structural equation modelling analysis which consists of two phases.

First, an exploratory factor analysis (EFA) was conducted to identify the dimensionality of the scales (Barrera Barrera & Cepeda Carrión, 2014; Kaynama & Black, 2000; Takeuchi et al., 2022). A principal component analysis with Varimax rotation was performed, and factors with eigenvalues greater than one were extracted. As a result, two dimensions were identified: 'Anticipated Feelings' and 'Artist Fame' each with four retained variables. The 'Anticipated Feelings' construct explained 77.009% of the variance, while 'Artist Fame' explained 64.744%. Cronbach's alpha values, ranging from 0.966 to 0.942, indicate good internal consistency amongst the items within each construct. Factor loadings, communalities, eigenvalues, and explained variance for each measurement statement are presented in Table 3. Additionally, to assess sample adequacy, the Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin (KMO) and Bartlett's tests were applied. The KMO index was 0.765 for 'Anticipated Feelings' and 0.774 for 'Artist Fame' suggesting that the sample is suitable for factor analysis. Bartlett's test of sphericity was significant for both constructs ($p < 0.001$), confirming the factorability of the data.

In this phase of the structural equation modelling analysis, the evaluation of the measurement model (MM) is evaluated. Convergent validity (CV) and discriminant validity (DV) of the MM model were tested by confirmatory factor analysis (CFA). The CFA was assessed through individual item reliability (Guerrero et al., 2015; Kim et al., 2023). Descriptive statistics and an assessment of normality for every construct's item were provided in Table 4, which includes skewness and kurtosis values along with their critical ratios. These metrics allow for a comprehensive evaluation of the data distribution and highlight any deviations from normality that could impact the analysis. The results of the CFA results (Table 5) showed that the constructs' elements were beyond the set limit of 0.70 (Hair et al., 2010). Regarding the reliability of the constructs, the values obtained were beyond the suggested figure of 0.7 (Hair et al., 2010). About the average variance extracted (AVE) and the Composite Reliability (CR), all the values were above the established limit of 0.5 (Triguero-Sánchez et al., 2022). Through the AVE and the CR, the convergent validity of the model was evaluated (Solakis et al., 2021). Cronbach's alpha is greater than 0.8. In Table 6 the discriminant validity is shown, which indicates that one construct is different from each other. And, finally, in Table 7 the Heterotrait-Monotrait Ration is reported, it is important to mention that this can only applied to the latent variables (Anticipated Feelings & Artist Fame), being not applicable for attendance. There are no warnings for the HTMT analysis (Gaskin & James, 2019; Henseler et al., 2015). Therefore, upon completion of the SEM-MM analysis, it will be possible to go back to the last phase of a structural equation modelling.

In the second last phase of the SEM-analysis, the structural model (see Fig. 2), was evaluated using the estimate of the explained variance (R^2) of the constructs. Subsequently, using indices from the categories of model fit, model suitability was analysed (Guerrero et al., 2015; Hair et al., 2010; Mahmoud et al., 2020). Regarding absolute fit, results suggested a good fit, with a GFI of 0.963 and an RMSEA of 0.054 (Browne & Cudeck, 1993; Jöreskog & Sörbom, 1984). Regarding the incremental fit, CFI and TLI were above 0.9, and as regards the parsimonious fit, chi-squared/df was 2.703, which is within the acceptable range of less than 3.0 (Marsh & Hocevar, 1985). The above analysis and the SM results are shown in Table 8, with the results indicating a suitable fit. The significance of the parameter estimates was assessed using *t-values* (C.R.) (Triguero-Sánchez et al., 2021). Finally, according to Efron and Tibshirani (1986), in order to avoid the lack of non-normality of the parameters, the bootstrapping bias-corrected test was used to evaluate the accuracy and stability of the estimates obtained (resample procedure of 2000 samples). Such a procedure with SEM-AMOS is broadly accepted in the social sciences, including economics, business, and psychology (Mahmoud et al., 2023; Malca et al., 2020; Solakis, Peña-Vinces, Lopez-Bonilla, et al., 2021).

Table 2
Specific bias test.

Specific Bias Test:	X^2	DF	Delta	pvalue
Unconstrained Model	168.000	709	$X^2 = 15.000$	1.000
Zero Constrained Model	183.000	927	DF = 218	

4.2. Structural equation modelling -results

Regarding *hypothesis 1* which evaluated if artist fame positively influence the customer's decision to attend a live flamenco show, on this matter, the structural equation modelling result ($\beta = -0.105$***) shows how hypothesis 1 must be rejected. In this sense, results do not support research published (Archer & Robb, 2024; Ramirez & Hagen, 2018) which has shown that in another context results are positive. As mentioned in the introduction, this is due to flamenco has some particulates became a unique genre. Additionally, the discussion and conclusion sections will provide additional explanations for why such negative results occurred within the flamenco music context.

Hypothesis 2 was focused on evaluating if the anticipated feelings created by an artist on a scenery will positively influence the customer's decision to attend a live flamenco show. The structural equation modelling result has shown positive effects ($\beta = 0.132$***), therefore, *hypothesis 2* is supported. The findings suggest that anticipated feelings are the unique variable that allows consumers to have a direct relationship with the artist. Humanistic and transpersonal theories (Montgomery et al., 2024) would suggest that people can feel a relatively direct response to music performed by artists. In the same direction, the theory of planned behaviour (Ajzen, 1985) supports the findings as it shows that previous experience of consumers with the flamenco has been determinant on the decision to attend a live flamenco show. Therefore, it seems reasonable to think that live flamenco shows must be seen before and after those consumers should generate their feelings (Pelowski, 2015). In fact, the rich variability of anticipated feelings seems to reflect a distinct kind of musical attendance.

Hypothesis 3 stated the importance that anticipated feelings might have on the perception of artist fame. In this respect, the results ($\beta =$

Table 3
EFA results of measures.

Constructs	Codes	Factor Loading	Communality	Eigen-Value	Variance Explained (%)	Cronbach's α value
Anticipated Feelings				3.08	77.009	0.966
	EM	0.873	0.761			
	RFL	0.782	0.611			
	FEEL	0.916	0.893			
	M_FELL	0.932	0.87			
Artist Fame				2.59	64.744	0.942
	T_SLS	0.754	0.569			
	IMAG	0.79	0.624			
	EXP	0.862	0.743			
	PUBL	0.809	0.654			

Table 4
Descriptive statistics and normality assessment.

Variable	Min.	Max.	Mean	SD	Skewness	c.r.	Kurtosis	c.r.
F_FELL	1.00	7.00	6.495	1.143	−2.924	−28.847	8.865	43.729
FEEL	1.00	7.00	6.435	1.194	−2.67	−26.34	7.309	36.056
RFL	1.00	7.00	5.694	1.524	−1.282	−12.646	1.137	5.606
EM	1.00	7.00	6.368	1.248	−2.487	−24.534	6.151	30.344
T_SLS	1.00	7.00	2.728	1.792	0.851	8.396	−0.248	−1.223
PUBL	1.00	7.00	4.748	1.831	−0.557	−5.499	−0.659	−3.249
EXP	1.00	7.00	3.920	1.844	−0.094	−0.923	−1.006	−4.964
IMAG	1.00	7.00	3.933	1.830	−0.093	−0.917	−0.968	−4.776
SEX	1.00	2.00	1.541	0.499	−0.165	−1.627	−1.973	−9.732
AGE2	1.00	5.00	2.644	1.375	0.289	2.853	−1.186	−5.85
K	1.00	7.00	3.887	1.450	−0.009	−0.085	−0.487	−2.403
AC_LEVEL	1.00	5.00	4.039	1.209	−0.897	−8.854	−0.495	−2.441
CONSUMPTION	1.00	2.00	1.704	0.457	−0.893	−8.806	−1.203	−5.936
Multivariate							56.125	34.34

Table 5
SEM-measurement model.

SEM-Measurement Model					
Constructs	**Codes**	**λ̂**	**α**	**AVE**	**CR**
Feelings			0.89	0.691	0.897
	EM	0.769			
	RFL	0.615			
	FEEL	0.918			
	M_FEEL	0.975			
Fame					
	IMAG	0.673	0.82	0.54	0.824
	EXP	0.84			
	PUBL	0.719			
	T_SLS	0.697			

Note: λ̂ = Loadings; a = Cronbach's Alpha Coefficient; AVE = Average Variance Extracted; CR= Composite Reliability.

Table 6
SEM discriminant validity.

SEM discriminant validity		
Construct	**Feelings**	**Fame**
Feelings	**0.8313**	
Fame	0.285[a]	**0.7348**

Note: The bold figures are the square root of the AVE. The normal figures are correlations between variables.
[a] Significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed). SPSS v.22.

Table 7
HTMT analysis.

Variable	Feelings	Fame
Feelings		
Fame	0.300	

0.285***) are consistent with previous research (Angelini & Castellani, 2019). Thus, such hypothesis is supported. Results suggest that anticipated feelings are motivators for attendance and are crucial to sustaining artist fame. Subsequently, it is not easy to determine what an artist is doing, although the emotional tone of the message (that is, how it is being performed) is distinct. The emotional tone of a performance directly affects the fame of artists. Emotions make people feel connected to others, and people need to feel safe regarding both their social relations with their peers as well as with their own identity (Jury et al., 2019; Luo, 2017). Due to these arguments, consumers' anticipated feelings increase artist fame. All of this ties in with the sense of belonging to the community and is therefore related to artists' brand development (Angelini et al., 2023).

In the examination of control variables, key sociodemographic factors (Menor-Campos et al., 2020; Roldán et al., 2023), including gender (Sex), age (Age), academic level (Academic Level), and knowledge of flamenco, were meticulously integrated with the intention of thoroughly controlling for heterogeneity amongst individuals and diminishing the potential significance of omitted variables (Heredia-Carroza et al., 2020). The inclusion of these variables aimed to bolster the robustness of this study, minimising confounding influences and ensuring a more accurate evaluation of the relationships under investigation.

Nevertheless, a noteworthy revelation pertains to the impact of consumer knowledge of flamenco on attendance at live flamenco shows (β = 0.411***). Intriguingly, certain statements indicate that discerning consumers with specialised knowledge of flamenco exhibit a pronounced preference for attending pure flamenco shows. This finding underscores the profound influence of individuals accumulated cultural capital, shaped by a lifetime consumption of cultural goods and the transmission of flamenco oral traditions within the community (Ateca-Amestoy and Prieto-Rodriguez, 2023; Heredia-Carroza et al., 2019). It suggests that a deeper understanding and appreciation of the intricacies of flamenco contribute significantly to the consumer's choice of attending specific types of flamenco performances. This insight further emphasises the dynamic interplay between cultural knowledge

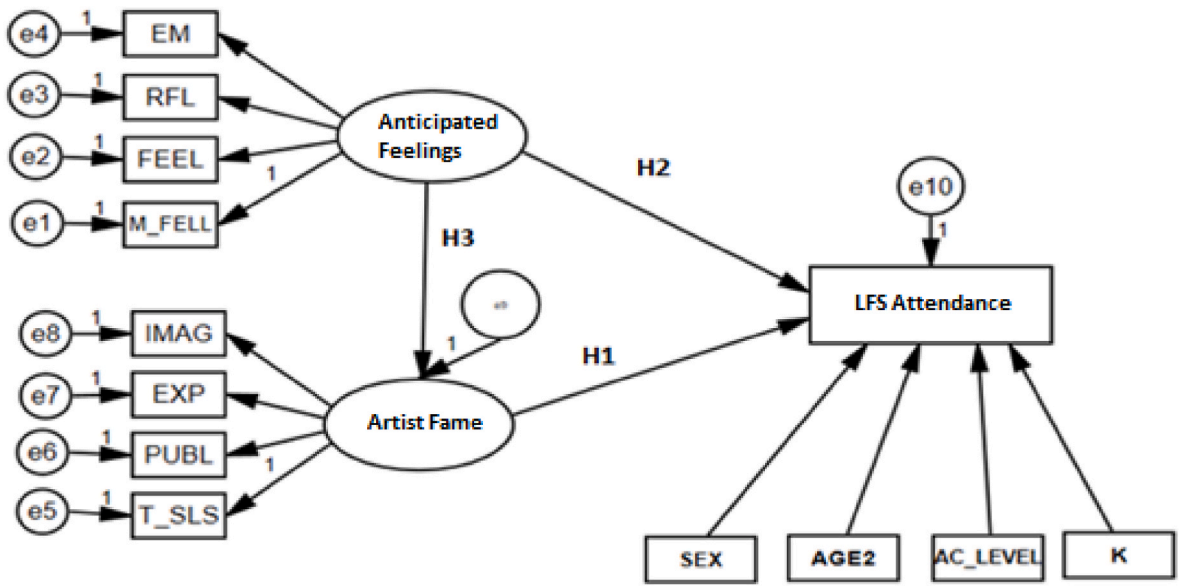

Fig. 2. The proposed model to be evaluated.

Table 8
SEM-results and null-hypothesis significance.

Hypotheses	N = 584				Bias-corrected Bootstrap 2000 subsamples CI 95%				
	β	S.E.	C.R.	p	Estimate	Lower	Upper	Sig./Sup	R2
Feelings→ Consumption	0.132	0.019	3.243	***	0.063	0.024	0.103	***	0.19
Fame→ Consumption	−0.105	0.016	−2.428	**	−0.039	−0.071	−0.009	***	
Feelings→ Fame	0.285	0.065	5.623	***	0.367	0.248	0.5	***	
Sex→ Consumption	0.02	0.035	0.064		0.002	−0.066	0.076		
Age→ Consumption	0.054	0.014	1.3		0.018	−0.008	0.043		
Academic Level → Consumption	0.054	0.016	1.303		0.02	−0.009	0.051		
Knowledge → Consumption	0.411	0.013	10.263	***	0.129	0.106	0.154	***	
Model fits	$X^2(df)$	X^2/df	**GFI**	**AGFI**	**CFI**	**IFI**	**TLI**	**NFI**	**RMSEA**
Results	145.967 (54)	2.703	0.963	0.937	0.97	0.97	0.956	0.953	0.054
Recommended	$p < 0.05$	<3	0–1	0–1	0–1	0–1	0–1	0–1	<0.08

and attendance behaviour within the realm of flamenco.

5. Discussions and conclusions

This study sheds light on the complex dynamics between artist fame, anticipated feelings, and live flamenco shows attendance, providing fresh insights that challenge established norms in the music industry (Djabarouti, 2021; Kakko & Isotalus, 2023). While artist fame has traditionally been viewed as a critical driver of success in the music market, the findings reveal a negative impact of artist fame on attendance at live flamenco shows, which deviates from expectations based on the Theory of Planned Behaviour (Borghans & Groot, 1998). This discovery invites a deeper interpretative exploration of how traditional popular music genres, such as flamenco, diverge from conventional frameworks.

According to Theory of Planned Behaviour, artist fame is expected to influence attendance decisions by shaping attitudes towards behaviour, subjective norms, and perceived behavioural control. Social pressure and perceived ease of access to high-profile shows often enhance the likelihood of attendance. However, the diminished role of artist fame in driving live flamenco shows attendance reflects the nuanced preferences of flamenco audiences, who value authenticity over commercialisation. Cultural commodification, while enhancing the visibility of renowned artists, may inadvertently erode the perceived authenticity that purist audiences seek (Cruces Roldán, 2001; Heredia-Carroza et al., 2019). This is particularly evident in minority genres like flamenco, where the loss of experiential authenticity due to over-commercialisation or mass-market branding can alienate specialised consumers. By contrast, anticipated feelings tap into the intrinsic emotional connection between audiences and the art form, reinforcing attitudes and subjective norms that favor attendance (García-García et al., 2024).

The interplay between fame and authenticity reveals a significant insight into consumer behaviour in cultural tourism. While artist fame contributes to the economic and social value of flamenco through branding and visibility (Rodner & Kerrigan, 2014; Schroeder, 2005), the loss of perceived authenticity can alienate core audiences. This phenomenon underscores the need for destination marketers and event organisers to balance the visibility provided by renowned artists with efforts to preserve flamenco's cultural essence. Over-commercialisation, inflated ticket prices, and an emphasis on financial motives detract from the purist appeal of flamenco, emphasising the nuanced relationship between artist fame and economic considerations (Velthuis, 2003).

Anticipated feelings emerge as a more influential motivator for attendance, playing a central role in fostering emotional engagement and creating memorable experiences (Anaya and Lehto, 2023; Tiwari et al., 2023). As proposed by Theory of Planned Behaviour, anticipated feelings influence attitude towards behaviour, subjective norms, and perceived behavioural control by evoking emotions such as pleasure, excitement, and cultural connection. These emotions enhance the perceived value of live flamenco shows, driving consumer loyalty and

strengthening the communal essence of flamenco (Ratnawati et al., 2024; Yi et al., 2024). Unlike artist fame, anticipated feelings are less susceptible to over-commercialisation, as they are rooted in the unique, non-replicable emotional experience provided by each performance (Burgdorf, 2024; Coman & Opazo, 2020).

This divergence highlights the value of integrating Social Cognitive Theory into the theoretical framework, as it underscores the importance of communal ties and shared emotional experiences in reinforcing attendance intentions. Flamenco's ability to evoke profound emotions and foster cultural connections creates a competitive advantage that distinguishes it from other genres. Marketing strategies that leverage anticipated feelings through storytelling, immersive technologies, and authentic narratives can attract a broader and more diverse audience while retaining the loyalty of purist consumers (Ahmed, 2004; Clarke et al., 2006).

The findings also advance the discourse on cultural tourism by highlighting how traditional popular music genres contribute to destination branding. While celebrity branding can enhance destination equity by associating well-known artists with specific locations, the success of such strategies depends on maintaining authenticity. For flamenco, this means celebrating the cultural richness of the genre and prioritising emotional resonance over market-driven approaches. The integration of artist fame into destination marketing must consider its impact on perceived authenticity to avoid alienating core audiences while attracting new ones.

Furthermore, the methodological approach of this study offers a blueprint for examining similar dynamics in other traditional music genres with strong local identities, such as country music, vallenato, and fado. By demonstrating how anticipated feelings and artist fame interact in the context of flamenco, this research provides a foundation for future studies exploring the balance between commercialisation and cultural preservation in traditional music.

The study contributes to the theoretical understanding of consumer behaviour and cultural tourism by demonstrating that the rejection of artist fame is not a universal phenomenon but a contextual response rooted in the values and expectations of purist audiences (Sheth et al., 1991). It also highlights how anticipated feelings serve as a universal motivator, transcending cultural boundaries and offering a tool for global marketing strategies. These insights underscore the importance of adapting theoretical frameworks to the unique characteristics of minority genres and provide actionable recommendations for industry stakeholders.

5.1. Implications

The implications of this study extend beyond the immediate impact on the music industry, offering valuable insights for destination marketing and the global promotion of cultural tourism. Recognising the central role of spectators' emotions in driving attendance, it becomes essential for music industry managers and destination marketers to foster a deeper connection between audiences and the unique cultural essence of live flamenco performances. By prioritising the emotional value of live flamenco shows alongside artist fame, innovative marketing strategies can be developed that not only showcase artistic excellence but also highlight the transformative emotional journey experienced by spectators.

The insights derived from this study can be applied to other culturally rich events worldwide, such as fado festivals in Portugal, tango performances in Argentina, or Vallenato festivals in Colombia. These genres share similar characteristics with flamenco, relying on their deep cultural identity and the emotional connection they establish with audiences. Destination marketers can leverage these findings to design campaigns that highlight the authenticity of these experiences, balancing cultural preservation with contemporary appeal. For example, showcasing the historical roots of these traditions alongside modern interpretations can attract both heritage enthusiasts and younger audiences seeking meaningful cultural experiences.

Anticipated feelings represent a significant opportunity for creating a global appeal for flamenco festivals. Marketing strategies could utilise storytelling and visual media to emphasise the emotional depth, authenticity, and communal essence of flamenco. Campaigns could highlight the transformative experiences that attendees can expect, focusing on universal emotions such as passion, connection, and tradition. For international audiences, integrating visual content such as video testimonials, immersive 360-degree experiences, or virtual reality performances could convey the unique emotional impact of flamenco. These tools allow potential tourists to preview the cultural richness and emotional resonance of flamenco before attending an event, bridging geographical and cultural gaps. While emotional engagement remains central to the success of cultural events, integrating digital tools can further enhance accessibility and global reach, ensuring a broader appeal without compromising authenticity (Ateca-Amestoy and Castiglione, 2023; Regner, 2015).

Similarly, these strategies can be adapted for other cultural events (Fisher et al., 2024), integrating advanced digital tools like augmented reality or community-driven storytelling to strengthen emotional engagement. For instance, virtual previews of traditional performances or localised narratives that showcase the cultural significance of these events could attract international audiences and boost tourism. This approach can be particularly impactful for emerging cultural festivals looking to establish their global identity (Lee et al., 2011).

Emotional marketing techniques, as outlined by Kotler et al. (2010) and Robinette and Brand (2001), can position flamenco as a unique cultural experience that transcends entertainment. For example, promotional campaigns could feature narratives of personal transformation inspired by flamenco or showcase the communal joy of shared performances. These strategies would not only attract cultural tourists seeking meaningful experiences but also strengthen flamenco's global identity as a celebration of intangible cultural heritage.

Artist fame, traditionally associated with market recognition and social prestige, can serve as a powerful tool in destination branding (Kalkhoff et al., 2017). By associating renowned flamenco artists with the cultural identity of hosting destinations, tourism authorities can enhance the perceived prestige of attending flamenco events. This aligns with the principles of celebrity branding, where globally recognised figures contribute to the destination's brand equity (McCracken, 1989; Rodner & Kerrigan, 2014). For instance, promotional campaigns could feature international tours of iconic flamenco artists, highlighting their connection to specific regions and emphasising the authenticity and cultural depth of these destinations (Aguado et al., 2024). However, balancing fame with authenticity is crucial. Over-commercialisation risks undermining the cultural essence that audiences value in flamenco. Marketing efforts should celebrate the historical and cultural richness of flamenco while leveraging artist fame to enhance visibility and attract diverse audiences. A dual strategy could involve featuring both iconic artists and emerging local talent, reinforcing the destination's commitment to preserving cultural heritage while showcasing its contemporary relevance.

Flamenco festivals can enhance their appeal to international tourists by focusing on the authentic and immersive nature of their events. Highlighting flamenco's UNESCO recognition as Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity can serve as a cornerstone for marketing campaigns, underscoring its cultural significance (Palma et al., 2017). Additionally, festivals could adopt audience segmentation strategies to cater to varying levels of familiarity with flamenco. For example, introductory performances or workshops for novices could coexist with specialised events for connoisseurs. Incorporating lesser-known flamenco styles and innovative collaborations with other art forms could broaden the appeal of performances, attracting diverse audiences. Technological advancements such as digital platforms, social media, and immersive tools like augmented or virtual reality could extend the reach of flamenco performances beyond physical event spaces (Bonini and

Magaudda, 2024; McKenzie et al., 2021). Virtual experiences that allow international audiences to engage with flamenco remotely could foster interest in visiting its cultural origins.

The findings of this study underline the importance of reinforcing the organic image of destinations through flamenco festivals. By positioning these events as key cultural attractions, destinations can enhance their identity and appeal. The integration of flamenco into broader destination marketing strategies not only fosters deeper connections between tourists and the cultural heritage of the region but also contributes to tourism growth and economic development. For instance, storytelling campaigns that connect flamenco with the history and traditions of its host region can create a unique narrative that differentiates the destination in competitive markets. Moreover, collaborations between tourism boards, cultural institutions, and local artists can strengthen the perceived authenticity of flamenco events. These partnerships can ensure that marketing efforts celebrate the cultural richness of flamenco while addressing the expectations of international audiences.

The global recognition of genres such as doina in Romania or gamelan in Indonesia provides a broader framework for applying the insights from this study to cultural events worldwide. Emphasising the balance between authenticity and emotional engagement can significantly enhance the appeal of these events, creating unique experiences that attract both local and international audiences. This approach also highlights the role of cultural tourism as a driver of sustainable development in regions rich in intangible heritage.

Ultimately, the success of flamenco shows hinges not only on the technical brilliance of the performers but also on the emotional resonance they create within audiences. By embracing and enhancing the emotional aspects of live flamenco music, industry stakeholders can adapt to evolving consumer expectations, attract a broader audience, and contribute to the ongoing preservation and global recognition of this rich cultural tradition. This study offers actionable insights for marketers and cultural stakeholders, demonstrating how a balance of authenticity, emotional engagement, and innovative strategies can drive the success of cultural tourism globally. These insights provide a robust foundation for integrating flamenco into destination marketing strategies, ensuring its relevance and appeal in an increasingly interconnected world.

5.2. Limitations and future research

This study's focus on usual flamenco consumers presents a limitation, as it does not account for how non-usual consumers, such as tourists, make their attendance decisions. Understanding this broader audience is crucial, as tourists often engage with flamenco differently, influenced by their pursuit of authentic cultural experiences. Future research should consider extending the analysis to include these diverse consumer groups for a more comprehensive understanding of flamenco attendance patterns.

Another potential extension of this work would be to study the interaction between anticipated feelings and brands and its effect on the revenues of flamenco artists. This relationship could reveal important insights into the economic impact of emotional engagement and branding strategies within the flamenco industry. Future research could also explore additional measures of live flamenco shows attendance, such as evaluating purely artistic facets like the artists' talent or the intrinsic value of the performances.

Qualitative research should be developed to explore the nuances behind the relationship between artist fame and attendance. This approach could uncover why certain consumers might reject more commercialised forms of music in favor of performances that adhere more closely to the roots and authenticity of traditional flamenco, providing a richer understanding of consumer motivations and preferences.

Further research could involve comparing these findings with other types of music recognised by UNESCO, such as *doina* (Romania), *fado* (Portugal), or *vallenato* (Colombia). This comparative analysis could determine whether the observed dynamics in flamenco are unique or extend to other traditional music genres globally. The phenomenon of 'artist fame without influence', observed in flamenco, could also be explored in other traditional music genres to assess its broader applicability.

Finally, it would be beneficial to explore how new technologies and digital platforms influence the live flamenco shows attendance, especially in the context of significant changes in live music due to external factors like the pandemic. Examining the impact of live streams, virtual experiences, or online interactions on perceptions and attendance decisions could offer a more comprehensive understanding of the contemporary landscape of the live flamenco shows attendance. Additionally, investigating the long-term effects of unexpected events, such as the pandemic, on flamenco preferences and behaviours could provide valuable insights for future industry adaptations.

By addressing these limitations and exploring these potential research avenues, future studies can build upon the findings of this research, contributing to a deeper and more nuanced understanding of live flamenco shows attendance and its broader implications for the music industry.

CRediT authorship contribution statement

Jesús Heredia-Carroza: Writing – review & editing, Writing – original draft, Visualization, Validation, Supervision, Software, Resources, Project administration, Methodology, Investigation, Funding acquisition, Formal analysis, Data curation, Conceptualization. **Jesús Peña-Vinces:** Writing – review & editing, Writing – original draft, Visualization, Validation, Supervision, Software, Methodology, Investigation, Formal analysis, Data curation. **Luis Palma:** Writing – original draft, Visualization, Validation, Conceptualization, Investigation, Writing – review & editing. **Luis F. Aguado:** Writing – review & editing, Writing – original draft, Visualization, Validation, Investigation, Conceptualization.

Declaration of competing interest

No potential conflict of interest is reported by the authors.

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Appendix I

Variables items and codes[1]

Code	
Consumer Profile	
Knowledge of flamenco	How good is your knowledge of flamenco?
(1) None (7) Expert level (2)	
Live flamenco shows attendance in the last year	Have you attended live flamenco shows over the last year?
(0) No (1) Yes	
Time consuming flamenco	How long have you been a consumer of flamenco?
(1) Less than a year (2) One to four years (3) Five to nine years (4) Ten or more years	
Measured variables	When evaluating a flamenco artist, the following elements are important:
(1) Totally in disagreement (7) Totally agreed	
Anticipated Feelings	
EM	Artist's ability to produce emotion in spectator
RFL	The artist's performance generates reflection in spectators
FEEL	Artist's ability to feel flamenco
M_FELL	Artist's ability to make others feel flamenco
Artist Fame	
T_SLS	Ticket sales levels of the live flamenco shows produced by the artist
IMAG	The artist's image
EXP	Expert's opinion about the artist
PUBL	Public's opinion about the artist
Socio-demographic aspects	
Gender	You are: Female/Male/Other
Age in years	You are …. … . years old
(1) Less than 30 (2) From 30 to 39 (3) From 40 to 49 (4) From 50 to 59 (5) 60 or more	
Level of education	What level of education have you completed?
(1) None (2) Elementary School (3) Secondary School (4) Upper Secondary School (5) Higher Education	

[1] An ANOVA analysis revealed that there were no significant differences in responses between those regular attendees and broader flamenco-engaged audiences.

Data availability

Data will be made available on request.

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